

Wednesday, 1 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Light rain

19° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

From retirement fears to triumphant Wimbledon return for GB's Swan.

Katie Swan gets her "full-circle moment" at Wimbledon, two years after considering retiring from tennis because of a persistent back injury.

UK · NEWS

2

Final warning for failing health board after nine years of special measures.

The Welsh government says it will take a more direct role in improving Wales' largest health board.

UK · NEWS

3

Shetland backs plan to connect islands with £1.5bn undersea tunnels.

The undersea links between some of the UK's most northerly islands could be in place within eight years.

UK · NEWS

4

Man denies murder of Scottish woman on Greek island in 2009.

Jean Hanlon was found dead in the water off the coast of Heraklion 17 years ago.

UK · NEWS

5

School trip surprise as students meet The Rock.

About 50 children from Sudbury meet Dwayne Johnson on a school visit to London.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Legally Blonde revival Elle - boring and tedious or a hot pink delight?.**
The spin-off introduces a new generation to Elle Woods, but critics say young people deserve better.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Lily Allen defends tour after some fans criticise show length.**
Some fans had complained that the show is too short because the singer only performs her latest album.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Signed Paul McCartney book found in charity shop sells for nearly £1,000.**
The book signed by the Beatles' star sat in an Oxfam stop for months before the manager found it.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Lilo & Stitch star Daveigh Chase's cause of death was Aids.**
The actress, who also crawled out of a TV in horror film The Ring, passed away in LA this month, aged 35.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Tributes paid to 'comic genius' Penelope Keith after her death aged 86.**
The beloved actress was known for roles in classic TV sitcoms The Good Life and To the Manor Born.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Brook would accept 'honour' of Test captaincy.**
Harry Brook says he would accept the England Test captaincy and believes it is possible to lead the country in all three formats.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Germany fans in need of hope as prospect of Klopp looms.**
As Germany again fail to progress at a World Cup BBC Sport looks at the fallout from their defeat by Paraguay and what happens next.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Three British players win but 14 out in first round.**
Katie Swan, Jacob Fearnley and Arthur Fery ensure home representation in the Wimbledon second round - but 14 home players fall to first-round defeats for the first time in 32 years.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Williams' Wimbledon legacy before return to Centre Court.**
A look back at Serena Williams' Wimbledon legacy to date, including her seven singles titles and remarkable comeback from retirement before her return to Centre Court.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Perry gives Australia injury scare in semi-final win.**
Ellyse Perry gives Australia an injury scare before Sunday's T20 World Cup final by retiring hurt during her side's semi-final win over West Indies.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'plant communication' and finding that trees can 'talk' to each other.**
New research suggests that trees use complex underground fungal networks, often called the 'wood wide web', to share nutrients and send warning signals about pests or disease to their neighbours.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'window shopping' is being highlighted as a free and cheerful way to lift your spirits.**
Psychologists suggest that browsing storefronts, even without buying, can provide a dose of visual stimulation and inspire future aspirations, making it a surprisingly effective mood booster.
- 3 A renewed interest in 'local history walks' is helping communities uncover fascinating stories right on their doorsteps.**
Organised tours and self-guided routes are encouraging people to explore the hidden heritage of their towns and villages, bringing to life the forgotten past of familiar places.
- 4 The humble 'doorstep delivery' from local greengrocers is seeing a resurgence, bringing fresh produce directly to homes.**
This traditional service is being embraced by those looking for convenience and a connection to local suppliers, ensuring a regular supply of seasonal fruit and vegetables.
- 5 Embracing the charm of 'second-hand bookshops' is becoming a popular pastime for many.**
The unique atmosphere, the thrill of discovery, and the sustainable aspect of giving books a new life are all contributing to the enduring appeal of these literary havens.
- 6 The delightful art of 'homemade lemonade' is making a refreshing comeback in kitchens across the country.**
Moving beyond store-bought options, people are experimenting with fresh lemons, different sweeteners, and even adding herbs like mint or basil for a personalised touch.
- 7 Researchers are noting the positive impact of 'communal gardening projects' on both mental well-being and local environments.**
These shared green spaces not only beautify neighbourhoods but also provide opportunities for social interaction, learning new skills, and enjoying the therapeutic benefits of nature.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our toast, even when we're in a hurry?

ANSWER: WAITING FOR THAT PERFECT MOMENT TO SPREAD THE BUTTER, SO IT MELTS JUST RIGHT.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'song' that we absolutely have to sing along to, even if we don't know all the words?

ANSWER: A CLASSIC ANTHEM FROM OUR TEENAGE YEARS.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you try a 'new way of making tea or coffee' – maybe a different type of milk, or a new brewing method – and it completely changes your morning routine for the better?
What little tweak have you made to your daily brew that you now can't live without?

- We all have those little 'comfort items' that we keep around the house – not necessarily valuable, but they hold a lot of sentimental worth, don't we?
What's that one item in your home that might seem ordinary to others, but means the world to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'. This term is believed to have originated from C.S. Lewis's 'The Chronicles of Narnia', where owls held a meeting.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins are the only birds that can swim but cannot fly. Their unique bone structure and wing shape are perfectly adapted for underwater propulsion.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, contrary to popular belief.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn, a mythical creature symbolising purity and innocence.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not, from a botanical perspective.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow, a fun fact often shared as a challenge.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.

On this day

Day 182 of the year, 183 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Catholic Church and Syriac Christianity); Christian feast day: Blessed Antonio Rosmini-Serbat; Christian feast day: Junípero Serra; Christian feast day: Julius and Aaron. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — John Ford, English-American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1962 — Andre Braugher, American actor (died 2023)
- 1956 — Alan Ruck, American actor
- 1943 — Jeff Wayne, American composer, musician and lyricist
- 1957 — Lisa Blount, American actress and producer (died 2010)
- 1952 — Dan Aykroyd, Canadian actor, producer and screenwriter
- 1951 — Fred Schneider, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 2001 — Chosen Jacobs, American actor and singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — The Northern Territory in Australia is granted self-government.
- 1983 — The Ministry of State Security is established as China's principal intelligence agency
- 1980 — "O Canada" officially becomes the national anthem of Canada.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Smoking in England is banned in all public indoor spaces.
- 1990 — German reunification: East Germany accepts the Deutsche Mark as its currency, thus uniting the economies of East and West Germany.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2020 — The United States–Mexico–Canada Agreement replaces NAFTA.
- 1983 — The Ministry of State Security is established as China's principal intelligence agency
- 2006 — The first operation of Qinghai–Tibet Railway is conducted in China.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 183 of the year, 182 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aberoh and Atom (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Bernardino Realino; Christian feast day: Blessed Eugénie Joubert; Christian feast day: Feast of the Visitation (Anglicanism; Levoča at Mariánska hora). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Paul Williams, American singer and choreographer (died 1973)
- 1970 — Steve Morrow, Northern Irish footballer and manager
- 1975 — Elizabeth Reaser, American actress
- 1985 — Ashley Tisdale, American actress, singer, and producer
- 1972 — Darren Shan, Irish author
- 1993 — Saweetie, American rapper
- 1920 — John Kneubuhl, Samoan-American historian, screenwriter, and playwright (died 1992)
- 1956 — Jerry Hall, American model and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1881 — Charles J. Guiteau shoots and fatally wounds U.S. President James A. Garfield (who will die of complications from his wounds on September 19).
- 1840 — A Ms 7.4 earthquake strikes present-day Turkey and Armenia; combined with the effects of an eruption on Mount Ararat, kills 10,000 people.
- 1966 — France conducts its first nuclear weapon test in the Pacific, on Moruroa Atoll.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1644 — English Civil War: Battle of Marston Moor.
- 1890 — The U.S. Congress passes the Sherman Antitrust Act.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)